

For example in India, a large number of people access internet through ADSL routers. These routers offer a web configuration interface usually hosted on “192.168.1.1”, however often this interface is also accessible from the router’s external IP address. So by scanning the list of MTNL IP addresses for example, one will run into many people who have their routers set up insecurely and can be configured remotely through the browser. Some of these might just have the default username and password. By accessing such an IP through the browser, one will be able to reconfigure the router and get a peek at the username and password of the end user.

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C:\>tracert www.twitter.com

Tracing route to twitter.com [128.242.240.20]
over a maximum of 30 hops:

  0  1 ms  1 ms  1 ms  192.168.1.1
  1  96 ms  202 ms  *  ABIS-North-Static-001.129.160.123.airtelbroadl
  2  *  *  144 ms  ABIS-North-Static-249.242.160.123.airtelbroadl
  3  *  *  *  Request timed out.
  4  203 ms  *  203 ms  AES-Static-114.36.144.59.airtel.in [59.144.36.
  5  *  *  *  Request timed out.
  6  *  475 ms  489 ms  ge-2-1-0.r03.engps102.sg.bb.gin.ntt.net [129.2
  7  *  *  *  Request timed out.
  8  463 ms  473 ms  436 ms  ae-2.r20.snjcsa04.us.bb.gin.ntt.net [129.250.2
  9  *  *  487 ms  ae-2.r20.nlpsca01.us.bb.gin.ntt.net [129.250.5
  10  *  *  *  Request timed out.
  11  580 ms  526 ms  547 ms  128.241.122.197
  12  450 ms  549 ms  535 ms  128.242.240.5
  13  513 ms  607 ms  543 ms  128.242.240.20

Trace complete.

C:\>
```

The road to Twitter is paved with 10 hops

There are applications such as SiteDigger, which include a large database of such common vulnerabilities in web sites. The SiteDigger application allows you to select from a list of vulnerabilities to test a web site for, and gives detailed information about the same.

Performing a trace-route is another way of getting information about the points along the way to a web site. The “tracert” command reveals information about the hops on the way to accessing a domain, and with this path revealed, we could have a better idea of how the system connected to a network. For example what the last hop is to the system itself, you can expect the second last hop to be to a router or firewall to control access to the server.

All this information is invaluable when constructing an attack, and it is important for us to know so we can know how to prevent such information from being abused. Often you will be surprised by the volume of intimate information available about your own organisation online.